

E-mail your personality

Every e-mail you send, contains clues about your personality. At least that is what scientists at the Edinburgh University believe, and have hence created a program that analyses your e-mails to sketch your personality. Christened Personality Style Checker, this tool can be used by corporate bodies to write letters that project a particular personality.

Spotting the personality is only a secondary function of the Personality Style Checker—it integrates with a word processor and can be used like a spell checker. When executed, the program will highlight the words that don't project the specified personality and offer alternative words that can be used.

The same technique can be used with incoming e-mails to detect the personality of the sender. By looking at the words used and punctuation style followed, the program picks out the personality type. The programs uses a database of set personality types that has been built by observing real-life human personalities, and their pattern of speech and writing.

snapshot

1.1 Terabytes of data were sent at **5.4 Gbps**—the fastest data transfer rate over the Internet—between **Geneva** and **California**

Source: CERN

SHIFTy anti-copying measures

All sorts of copy protection schemes have been devised to protect CD content, but here comes the easiest one to bypass. SunnComm's copy protection technology was used by BMG in a recent Anthony Hamilton Audio CD. Princeton PhD student, John Halderman, found out the anti-



copying measures were circumvented, by as little as holding down a strategic key. What John Halderman learnt was that simply holding down the [Shift] key would prevent the anti-copying program from loading up using the Windows autorun feature, hence circumventing the measures.

Both BMG and SunnComm say that they knew about this, and they claim that the protection measures, though easily breached, are enough to deter casual listeners from copying them. In fact, in an effort to appease digital music junkies, BMG has also included pre-ripped tracks on the CD that could

be then played on a computer, and be copied, though limited number of times. Another

interesting development was that shortly after the Princeton student put up his paper on the anti-copying technology used on his Web site, SunnComm threatened a lawsuit, claiming losses to the tune of \$10 million, but later retracted following an intense barrage of criticism by e-mail.

TV on pipe

Within the next 2 years, the biggest competitor to cable TVs could be computer cable TV. Taking a head start in this race to provide IPTV (Internet Protocol based Television), Reliance Infocomm, has collaborated with Microsoft to provide quality television broadcasts and video on-demand services. After having laid the required cabling for their countrywide high-speed network, Reliance is looking forward to offer people broadband access to the Internet, with Web surfing and multiplayer online gaming. They are also looking at piping in TV through the network,



Reliance
Growth is Life

proving users access to over 1,000 channels of cable TV. Microsoft, in turn, is providing the software support needed to run the network. Also, with the steady acceptance of the Windows Media Player 9 compression technology, Microsoft claims that they can offer standard broadcast quality television over an Internet connection of 1 MBps. Of course, there are stumbling blocks, such as the availability of cheap set-top boxes that could receive and decode Internet TV, but both Microsoft and Reliance Infocomm are optimistic.



heroes

Extreme processors
Intel and AMD have released the desktop version of server processors that have loads of cache to better their performance. Their target audience of the Pentium Extreme edition and the Athlon64 FX are targeted squarely at gaming enthusiasts, who have deep pockets and a huge appetite for performance.

Indian Mobile Market

With a 100 per cent growth rate in the cell phone market, the number of Indian mobile subscribers are set to exceed those with a landline connection by the end of 2004. The Indian market is known to be one of the fastest growing mobile phone markets in the world.



zeroes

OS/2-powered ATM

Bank ATM machines are set to shed their loyalty to OS/2 and move to Windows, since IBM is discontinuing support after the year 2006. Although IBM is officially encouraging migration to Linux, two large ATM vendors have already switched to Windows.

Exploding Mobiles

Three Nokia mobile phones—two in The Netherlands and the third in Vietnam—exploded with in a span of two months. Nokia claims that counterfeit batteries were the culprits behind the explosions, though that is proved to be the reason for only two of them. A Kyocera phone also exploded in a car in Nebraska, USA—the cause for this one is still unknown.